

SONARA — PHASE 5E

Final Visual Implementation Specification

Quiet Editorial × Native Flow

0. Design Direction

Sonara should feel like a **real, exceptionally polished native Android music application** that happens to have a distinctive visual identity.

The interface must never feel like a web application adapted to Android, nor like an experimental design showcase.

The governing principle is:

Android provides the grammar. Sonara provides the personality.

Native Android interaction patterns, information density, scrolling behavior, navigation, touch targets, media controls, and component logic take priority.

Sonara's identity comes through:

- Petrol / Bone / Oxide color language
- Quiet editorial typography
- Strong hierarchy
- Restrained spacing
- Artwork-led content
- Extremely controlled use of Oxide
- Minimal visual noise
- Phosphor Icons
- Consistent tonal surfaces
- Deliberate whitespace

The design should feel **quiet, mature, functional, and confident.**

Nothing should exist merely to make a screenshot look interesting.

1. Core Design Principles

1.1 Native first

Every interaction should feel immediately understandable to an Android user.

Use familiar patterns for:

- Top app bars
- Bottom navigation
- Horizontal media shelves
- Vertical media lists
- Scrolling
- Search
- Playback controls
- Menus
- Bottom sheets where already appropriate
- Touch targets
- System gestures
- System-level feedback

Do not invent interaction patterns simply to make Sonara distinctive.

1.2 Aggressive minimalism

If an element does not communicate information, provide an action, establish hierarchy, or improve navigation, it should probably not exist.

Prefer:

content + whitespace + typography

over:

content + container + border + decoration + shadow

1.3 Quiet editorial personality

Editorial character comes from:

- Typography
- Scale
- Spacing
- Composition

- Content ordering
- Artwork

It does NOT come from:

- Paper metaphors
- Decorative illustrations
- Graphic ornaments
- Experimental section boundaries
- Oversized hero treatments
- Magazine-like frames

The interface should feel editorial **without pretending to be a magazine.**

1.4 Artwork is the visual focus

Music artwork should provide most of the visual richness.

The UI surrounding artwork should remain quiet.

Artwork should never be unnecessarily enclosed in decorative cards or frames.

1.5 Oxide means action

Oxide is not a general-purpose brand decoration.

Reserve Oxide primarily for:

- Active playback
- Selected/active states
- Progress
- Important interactive emphasis
- Playback-related indicators
- Occasionally a critical contextual action

Do not flood the interface with Oxide.

2. Home Screen Hierarchy

The Home screen should use a **continuous vertical content flow.**

There should be no large dashboard-style hero.

Recommended hierarchy:

1. Top App Bar
2. Small contextual greeting
3. Resume / Continue Listening
4. Recently Played
5. Featured Artists
6. Curated Playlists
7. Quick Picks
8. Recommendations
9. Bottom navigation
10. Frozen MiniPlayer occupying its existing persistent position

The exact content availability may change depending on real data.

Empty sections should simply disappear or collapse.

Do not create artificial placeholders merely to preserve visual symmetry.

3. Top App Bar

The top app bar should be restrained and native.

Structure

Left:

Sonara wordmark

Right:

- Search
- Overflow / contextual action where required

Avoid filling the bar with icons.

Behavior

The app bar should remain visually quiet while scrolling.

No dramatic transformations.

No oversized collapsing header.

No decorative background treatment.

Logo

Use the established Sonara wordmark exactly as defined by the existing identity.

Do not redesign the logo as part of this phase.

4. Greeting

The greeting is contextual rather than promotional.

Examples:

- Good morning
- Good afternoon
- Good evening

Typography should be noticeably larger than section labels but substantially smaller than a hero heading.

The greeting should establish the beginning of the Home content without consuming excessive vertical space.

No subtitle such as:

"Here's what's happening in your musical world"

unless real product requirements justify it.

The interface should get to the music quickly.

5. Resume / Continue Listening

This is the primary Home-level playback context.

It should be compact.

Treatment

Use:

- Artwork
- Track title
- Artist

- Existing playback/progress information
- Play/resume affordance

The surrounding treatment should be a **quiet tonal surface**, not a large promotional card.

The Resume area should feel like a natural part of the content flow.

It should never dominate the screen.

Priority

Resume is important because it answers:

"What can I continue immediately?"

It is not intended to answer:

"What is the visual centerpiece of this screen?"

6. Recently Played

Recently Played should be highly scannable.

Use compact horizontal or vertical media content depending on available space.

Preferred treatment:

- Small artwork
- Track title
- Artist
- Optional duration
- Overflow action where required

Avoid individual floating cards around every item.

Subtle separators may be used where necessary.

The section header should be compact:

Recently played More →

"More" should remain secondary.

7. Featured Artists

Featured Artists should be an **artwork-first horizontal row**.

Recommended structure:

- Circular artist image
- Artist name underneath
- Horizontal scrolling

Artwork should provide the visual interest.

Avoid:

- Rings
- Decorative borders
- Floating badges
- Large labels
- Oversized portraits

The row should feel like a familiar Android media shelf, but with Sonara's typography and spacing.

8. Curated Playlists

Curated Playlists should introduce slightly more visual variety without becoming a card grid.

Preferred treatment:

- Horizontal artwork
- Playlist title
- Small supporting metadata where useful

Possible formats:

Option A — Compact horizontal row

[ART] Playlist Name
24 songs

Option B — Small artwork shelf

```
[ ART ] [ ART ] [ ART ]  
Title   Title   Title
```

Choose the format according to content density.

Do not mix multiple visual treatments unnecessarily.

Consistency is more important than novelty.

9. Quick Picks

Quick Picks is the utility-heavy section.

It should be one of the densest sections on Home.

Recommended:

```
[art]  Track title      :  
       Artist  
  
[art]  Track title      :  
       Artist  
  
[art]  Track title      :  
       Artist
```

Small artwork.

Strong track title.

Quiet artist metadata.

Minimal interaction affordances.

This section should feel extremely fast to scan.

Quick Picks should reinforce the idea that Sonara is an **actual music application**, not an editorial content platform.

10. Recommendations

Recommendations should follow the same structural language as the rest of Home.

No special recommendation container.

No giant "For You" hero.

No elaborate recommendation graphic.

A simple section heading followed by real music content is sufficient.

Examples:

- Recommended for you
- Because you listened to...
- You may like
- More like this

The recommendation engine can provide personality.

The UI does not need to.

11. Section Headers

Section headers establish hierarchy without becoming graphical objects.

Preferred structure:

Section title More

Typography:

- Section title: strong but compact
- More: smaller and quieter
- No enclosing pill
- No decorative line
- No oversized heading

Section spacing should provide the separation.

Whitespace should do the work that cards and borders previously did.

12. Spacing and Density

The interface should feel **comfortable but information-efficient**.

Use a consistent spacing scale throughout the application.

Recommended conceptual rhythm:

- Small internal gaps: ~4–8dp
- Metadata gaps: ~2–4dp
- Standard content gaps: ~12–16dp
- Section spacing: ~24–32dp
- Major screen-level spacing: ~32–40dp

Do not interpret these as rigid values before validating against Android typography and accessibility requirements.

The principle is:

Dense within components, generous between sections.

This produces the Quiet Editorial feeling without making the application sparse to the point of inefficiency.

13. Artwork Sizing

Artwork should follow a small number of deliberate sizes.

Compact media rows

Approximately:

48–64dp

Used for:

- Quick Picks
- Recently Played
- Compact playlists

Standard shelves

Approximately:

72–112dp

Used for:

- Playlists
- Albums
- Featured content

Artist artwork

Approximately:

56–72dp circular

depending on available width.

Large artwork

Only use larger artwork where it genuinely improves music discovery.

Do not introduce a huge Home hero simply because album art looks attractive at a larger size.

14. Artwork Treatment

Artwork should generally be displayed **cleanly and directly**.

Avoid:

- Borders
- Decorative frames
- Fake shadows
- Gradient overlays
- Ornamental masks
- Stickers
- Badges
- Artificial texture

Corner radius should be restrained and consistent with the native Android visual language.

The artwork itself should be allowed to provide visual variation.

15. Typography

Typography is one of the primary Sonara identity mechanisms.

The hierarchy should be strong without being loud.

Level 1 — Screen identity

Sonara wordmark / primary screen identity.

Level 2 — Context

Greeting or equivalent contextual heading.

Level 3 — Section heading

Examples:

Recently played

Featured artists

Quick picks

Level 4 — Primary content

Track, album, artist, or playlist title.

Level 5 — Supporting metadata

Artist name, duration, song count, secondary information.

The distinction between levels should come primarily from:

- Size
- Weight
- Contrast
- Spacing

Do not use excessive font sizes to manufacture hierarchy.

16. Typography Personality

The editorial character should be subtle.

Typography should feel:

- Calm
- Precise

- Slightly sophisticated
- Highly legible
- Confident

Avoid:

- Giant display typography
- Excessive uppercase text
- Decorative serif-heavy compositions
- Extremely thin text
- Fashion-editorial typography that compromises readability

The application remains a utility first.

17. Component Treatment

Components should generally be **flat or tonal**, not floating.

Preferred

- Tonal surfaces
- Subtle elevation only when functionally necessary
- Clean media rows
- Minimal dividers
- Consistent corner treatment
- Native Android touch feedback

Avoid

- Card stacks
- Nested cards
- Cards inside cards
- Heavy shadows
- Excessive rounded containers
- Glassmorphism
- Gradient surfaces
- Floating decorative panels

A container should exist because it communicates grouping or interaction—not because every piece of content needs a box.

18. Dividers

Dividers should be used sparingly.

Their purpose is structural separation, not decoration.

Prefer:

- Very subtle tonal dividers
- Section whitespace
- Alignment

Do not divide every piece of content if spacing already establishes hierarchy.

19. Dark / Petrol Mode

Dark mode should be the strongest expression of Sonara's identity.

Foundation

Petrol

Petrol should establish the environment rather than being treated as a bright accent.

Text

Use Bone for primary text.

Secondary text should use restrained lower-contrast Bone values.

Oxide

Oxide is reserved for:

- Active playback
- Progress
- Selected states
- Important actions

Surfaces

Use very subtle tonal variation between:

- Base background
- Navigation surface
- MiniPlayer surface
- Interactive surfaces

The difference should often be perceived rather than immediately noticed.

No gradients.

No glowing Petrol.

No excessive contrast between every surface.

20. Bone / Light Mode

Light mode is not simply "dark mode inverted."

Bone becomes the foundation.

Petrol becomes the primary structural/text color.

The result should feel:

- Warm
- Quiet
- Clean
- Slightly tactile
- Sophisticated

Avoid pure-white application backgrounds unless required by system/accessibility considerations.

Bone should provide Sonara's recognizable light-mode atmosphere.

Oxide remains an action/state color.

Do not increase the amount of Oxide merely because the background is light.

21. Phosphor Icons

Phosphor Icons are the preferred icon system.

Use a consistent Phosphor weight throughout the interface.

Icons should generally be:

- Simple
- Geometric
- Recognizable
- Quiet

Prefer icons over textual substitutes when an established Android interaction convention exists.

Examples:

- Search
- More
- Play
- Pause
- Chevron/right
- Library
- Home
- Queue
- Favorite

Do not use icons as decoration.

Every icon should have an interaction or information purpose.

22. Navigation

Use familiar Android bottom navigation.

Primary destinations should remain limited.

Recommended structure:

Home | Library | Search

or the already-established equivalent if product architecture requires it.

Rules

- Persistent
- Stable
- Easy to reach
- Clear active state
- Minimal labels/icons
- No experimental navigation model

The active destination should be identifiable primarily through subtle emphasis and Oxide/state treatment.

Do not turn navigation into a visual centerpiece.

23. MiniPlayer — FROZEN

ABSOLUTE CONSTRAINT

The existing MiniPlayer is **frozen**.

This Phase 5E visual refinement must **not redesign it**.

Do not change:

- Layout
- Control placement
- Hierarchy
- Interaction model
- Progress rail
- Progress behavior
- Artwork relationship
- Playback controls
- Gesture behavior
- Expansion behavior
- Fundamental dimensions

The existing MiniPlayer should be treated as an established Sonara component.

Only permitted visual adaptation

Create the correct **Bone/light-mode adaptation** while preserving the existing component's identity.

That means adapting:

- Background/surface color
- Text contrast
- Icon contrast
- Active Oxide state
- Artwork presentation where necessary for contrast

The MiniPlayer should visually belong to both themes without becoming a new design.

24. Relationship Between Home and MiniPlayer

The Home screen should be designed **around the frozen MiniPlayer**, not compete with it.

Home content should naturally terminate above the persistent playback layer.

There should be enough bottom content padding to ensure the MiniPlayer never obscures interactive content.

The MiniPlayer should feel like:

the persistent playback layer of the operating interface

rather than a separate card floating above the application.

25. Motion

Motion should be functional and restrained.

Use motion for:

- Navigation transitions
- Playback state changes
- Expand/collapse
- Press feedback
- Content loading where appropriate

Avoid:

- Decorative parallax
- Excessive artwork animation
- Large entrance animations
- Continuous movement
- Motion used purely for visual spectacle

The interface should feel calm even when animated.

26. Android Interaction Rules

The implementation must respect native Android expectations for:

- Touch target sizes
- System back behavior
- Scroll behavior
- Accessibility
- Dynamic text sizing
- Content descriptions
- Focus behavior
- Edge-to-edge behavior

- System bars
- Gesture navigation
- Loading/error states

Do not sacrifice usability for visual purity.

Aggressive minimalism means **removing unnecessary UI**, not making necessary UI smaller or harder to use.

27. What Is Explicitly Forbidden

The following are now explicitly outside the Phase 5E direction:

Visual metaphors

- Torn paper
- Ripped edges
- Journal pages
- Paper textures
- Scrapbook elements
- Orbit graphics
- Editorial collage metaphors
- Abstract Sonara "worlds"

Decorative UI

- Ornamentation
- Decorative borders
- Decorative dividers
- Gratuitous illustrations
- Stickers
- Badges without functional meaning
- Floating decorative shapes

Excessive containers

- Card stacks
- Nested cards
- Card grids everywhere
- Large rounded containers
- Excessive pills
- Heavy shadows
- Glass cards

Visual effects

- Gradients
- Glow effects
- Excessive blur
- Artificial depth
- Heavy drop shadows
- Decorative textures

Layout

- Oversized hero sections
- Huge greeting blocks
- Full-screen editorial features
- Excessively sparse screens
- Desktop/web dashboard patterns
- Dense multi-column layouts inappropriate for Android

Branding misuse

- Oxide used everywhere
- Logo used decoratively
- Brand marks replacing standard controls
- Sonara identity expressed through novelty rather than restraint

Conceptual design behavior

Anything that makes a reviewer think:

"That's a cool UI concept."

instead of:

"That's an excellent music app."

should be reconsidered.

28. Production-Level Visual Test

Before implementation is considered successful, the Home screen should pass this test:

First impression

It should immediately read as:

Android music application.

Second impression

It should clearly read as:

Sonara.

Third impression

The user should notice:

the music, not the interface.

The visual hierarchy should therefore be:

Music → usability → Sonara personality → decoration

And because decoration is almost entirely removed:

Music → usability → Sonara personality

29. Final Visual Formula

The final Sonara Home screen can be reduced to:

Native Android structure

+

quiet editorial typography

+

artwork-led content

+

Petrol / Bone environmental palette

+

Oxide for meaningful state

+

generous section spacing

+

compact media lists

+

minimal tonal surfaces

=

Sonara

The interface should never need to explain its identity.

It should simply feel coherent.

30. Final North Star

The target is not:

"A beautiful redesign of Sonara."

The target is:

"A music app that feels so naturally designed that it seems impossible that Sonara could have looked any other way."

The final implementation should feel as though the Sonara identity and native Android interaction model were designed together from the beginning.

No new metaphor.

No new concept.

No visual spectacle.

No web-app behavior.

Just:

Android clarity.

Sonara character.

Music first.

Nothing unnecessary.